

Samsung Galaxy A36 5G

A visual delight with some trade-offs

Samsung birthed the Galaxy A series line of mid-range smartphones over 10 years ago and has shipped more than 89 million phones since. Samsung has thrown its hat in the ring once again with the Galaxy A36, priced at Rs 32,999 in India. On paper it promises a lot: a stunning Super AMOLED display, a capable Snapdragon processor, and a powerful triple-camera setup. But is the Galaxy A36 5G just another mid-range device or does it bring enough to the table to justify its price tag? Let's see whether Samsung's latest A series phone is a hit or miss.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Samsung Galaxy A36 5G has a plastic frame, but it feels good in the hands. It is now the thinnest phone in the Galaxy A3x lineup with a 7.4mm thickness. The back has a glossy finish that shifts colour slightly in different lighting conditions, which adds a stylish touch. However, this glossy back panel tends to attract fingerprints and smudges quite easily, so you might find yourself wiping it down frequently or slapping a case on it. Either way, it's not too heavy or too light, making it comfortable to use for hours at a stretch. Despite the plastic build, the phone feels sturdy enough to handle everyday bumps and knocks, thanks to the Gorilla Glass Victus+ protection both on the front and the back.

At the back, you'll see the camera setup neatly arranged in a singular protruding module rather than sitting flush with the rest of the back panel as on the Galaxy A35. This design is clean and doesn't stick out too much.

₹32,999



Overall, the design is simple yet modern, striking a good balance between aesthetics and functionality.

DISPLAY

The front of the phone has a big screen with a punch-hole for the front camera, giving you plenty of screen space for watching videos or playing games. It features a 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED panel that delivers vibrant colours, deep contrasts, and remarkable clarity.

In our display tests, the A36's screen achieved an impressive 2020 nits of peak brightness in adaptive mode, ensuring a comfortable viewing experience even under the brightest conditions.

Furthermore, the Galaxy A36's colour accuracy is outstanding. Our testing with professional grade Calman and Spectral Colorimeter revealed a Delta E of 1 in the sRGB colour space, indicating near-perfect

colour reproduction. The display also covers 100% of the sRGB colour gamut, ensuring the entire coverage of hues across different conditions is covered.

Based on these comprehensive tests, it's clear that the Galaxy A36's display is excellent. Notably, the SDR performance of this phone is comparable to that of the flagship Galaxy S25 Ultra's SDR performance. The Galaxy A36's display offers a flawless and immersive viewing experience in this segment, setting a new standard for mid-range smartphones.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to performance, the Samsung Galaxy A36 5G is powered by the Snapdragon 6 Gen 3 processor. This chip delivers a noticeable boost in power compared to the previous generation. The benchmark tests show this improvement, with an AnTuTu score of 6,46,844, a Geekbench single-core score of 1,027, and a Geekbench multi-core score of 2,968. These numbers confirm that the A36 5G is indeed more capable than its predecessor.

While these scores are higher than the A35 scores, it's worth noting that other phones in the same price range offer even higher benchmark figures. However, in daily use, the Samsung Galaxy A36 5G feels smooth and responsive. Whether browsing apps, watching videos, or playing casual games, the phone handled everything without any noticeable lag or stutters. It helps that the display has a 120Hz refresh rate which makes everything smooth and fluid in action.

For casual gaming, the A36 5G performs well. But if you're into intensive gaming, the experience may not be as smooth. I played BGMI for 15 minutes with HDR-Extreme graphic settings, and the phone struggled to keep up. I faced constant lags, and the device got extremely heated, making it uncomfortable to hold. So, while its performance is more than adequate for light gaming, it may not be the best pick for competitive mobile gamers.